

WAHAROA

Case support for people, not paperwork

Adviser User Guide

For counsellors and clinical advisers managing Counselling cases

Version 1.0

Audience: Advisers (counsellors, financial mentors, case managers)

Scope: Adviser features currently live in Waharoa, with a focus on the Counselling case type.

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1. About Waharoa

Waharoa gives your clients a calm, plain-English view of their case: where it is up to, what is still needed from them, and what happens next. As an adviser you work behind that view — you keep the case record accurate, request and review evidence, record submissions, and maintain the clinical and funding detail for Counselling cases.

Who sees what

Role	What they can see
Client	Only their own cases, documents, evidence requests, submissions, timeline and budget.
Adviser	Only cases assigned to them, plus the documents, evidence, submissions and budget on those cases. Adviser notes are private to advisers and admins.
Admin	All clients, all advisers, all cases. Creates cases, assigns advisers and manages users.

Access is enforced in the database, not just in the screens. If a case has not been assigned to you, it does not appear anywhere in your account.

Signing in

1. Go to the Waharoa site and choose Sign in.
2. Enter your work email address and password. Use the eye icon to check what you have typed.
3. You land on the Adviser dashboard. If you also hold a client account, Waharoa routes you to the adviser view automatically.

Forgot your password? Use the reset link on the sign-in page. Social sign-in (Google, Apple) is temporarily hidden while provider setup is finalised.

2. The Adviser dashboard

Your dashboard is the first screen after sign-in. It has two parts.

Your numbers

Tile	What it counts
Active cases	Cases assigned to you that are not closed.
Waiting for client	Cases sitting at status Waiting for Client — the client owes you something.
Ready to submit	Cases where the evidence is complete and the next step is external submission.
Documents to review	Uploaded documents across your cases that no one has accepted or rejected yet.

Your cases

Below the tiles is every case assigned to you. Each card shows the client's name, the case title, the organisation, the deadline, who acts next, and a status badge.

- Open — takes you straight to the case edit screen, where you maintain the case record.
- From the edit screen you can jump to the Case workspace (evidence, documents, submissions, activity log) and to Budget & debts.

If the dashboard says "No cases assigned to you yet", ask your administrator to assign a case to you. Advisers cannot self-assign.

3. Case statuses and what they mean to the client

The status you choose drives the progress tracker your client sees. Choose the status that describes reality — it is the main way the client understands their case.

Status	Client sees	Use it when
Draft	Information requested	The case has been created but work has not started.
Waiting for Client	Documents uploaded	You are waiting on the client for consent, documents or a reply.
Adviser Reviewing	Adviser review	You have what you need and are working through it.
Ready to Submit	Ready to submit	The pack is complete and ready to go to the funder or provider.
Submitted	Submitted	You have sent the referral or application externally.
Under Review	Under review	The external agency or provider is considering it.
More Information Requested	Under review	The agency has come back asking for more.
Decision Made	Decision	An outcome has been received.
Closed	Decision	The case is finished and no further work is planned.

Progress (%) is a separate field on the case. Set it alongside the status so the client's tracker feels honest — for example 40% at Adviser Reviewing.

4. Counselling cases — the edit screen

Counselling is the prioritised case type. When Case type is set to Counselling, the edit screen shows three extra sections built for clinical work: Client & referral, Provider & sessions, and Clinical context.

To reach it: Adviser dashboard → Open on the case. Your changes are held until you press Save changes (top right on desktop, fixed at the bottom on mobile). Waharoa warns you if you try to leave with unsaved changes.

4.1 Case basics

Field	Guidance
Title	What the client will see, in plain language. For example "Counselling – Clinical Psychology".
Organisation	The service holding the case, e.g. Tū Ora.
Case type	Counselling. Changing this changes which sections appear.
Status	See section 3.
Deadline	Any hard date — funding expiry, review date, agency cut-off.
Progress (%)	0–100. Keep it consistent with the status.
External reference	The reference used by the funder or provider so records can be reconciled.
NHI (optional)	Seven characters, three letters then four digits (e.g. AAA1234). Leave blank if you do not need it.

4.2 Client & referral

- Referral source — who referred the client (GP, self, ACC, MSD, another service).
- Referral date — the date the referral was received, not the date you opened the case.
- Funding stream — ACC, MSD, DHB / Te Whatu Ora, Self-funded, or Other. This is what drives entitlement questions later.

4.3 Provider & sessions

- Counsellor / provider name — the practitioner or practice delivering the sessions.
- Next appointment — date and time of the next session.
- Sessions approved — how many sessions the funder has authorised.
- Sessions used — how many have been delivered. Update after each session so the remaining balance is always right.

Sessions approved and used are the fields most often out of date. Updating Sessions used immediately after a session is the single most useful habit in Waharoa.

4.4 Clinical context

- Presenting concerns — a short, factual summary of why the client is here.

- Risk flags — tick any of Suicidality, Family violence, Substance use, or None. Ticking a flag does not trigger an alert; it makes risk visible to whoever picks the case up next.
- Cultural considerations — whānau involvement, tikanga, language and interpreter needs, preferred kaimahi.
- Consent status — Not obtained, Verbal, or Written. Keep this current; it governs what you may share.

Follow your own service's clinical record-keeping policy. Waharoa is a coordination tool — it is not a clinical notes system, and the Clinical context fields should hold summary information only.

4.5 Workflow

- Next action — one sentence the client can act on, e.g. "Return your signed consent form".
- Who acts next — Client, Adviser, or the agency name. This shows on the client's dashboard.
- Adviser notes (private) — internal only. Clients never see this field.

5. The case workspace

From the edit screen, choose Case workspace. This is where day-to-day case activity happens.

5.1 Evidence requests

An evidence request tells the client exactly what to send. It appears on their dashboard under "What we need", with an Upload button attached.

1. Choose New request.
2. Pick a category (medical evidence, proof of income, bank statements, hardship explanation, other) and give it a clear title.
3. Add a description in plain English, and a due date if there is one.
4. Create the request. The client is notified and the case timeline records it.

Write requests the way you would say them out loud: "A letter from your GP confirming your referral" beats "Medical documentation".

5.2 Documents

Documents are stored privately. They are only reachable through short-lived signed links generated when you click to view.

- Upload — you can upload on the client's behalf (for example a consent form completed in person).
- View — opens the file in a new tab via a signed link.
- Accept — the document meets the requirement.
- Needs replacement — unreadable, expired, or the wrong document. The client sees this and can re-upload.
- Ready to submit — the document is part of the pack going out.

Each decision is recorded in the activity log and reflected in the client's view, so they always know whether something has landed.

5.3 Submissions

Use Record submission when something has been sent outside Waharoa — a referral emailed to a provider, an application lodged with a funder.

- Recipient organisation, submission date and method (email, portal, post, phone).
- Reference number returned by the recipient, if any.
- Follow-up date, so the case does not go quiet.
- Tick the documents included in the submission.

5.4 Activity log

Every meaningful event — assignment, status change, evidence requested, document uploaded or reviewed, submission recorded — is written to the case timeline with a timestamp. Use it for handovers, supervision and audit.

6. Budget & debts

Counselling clients often carry financial stress. The Budget & debts screen holds Client Voices–style budget sessions alongside the case.

- Create a blank session, or import one from an uploaded Client Voices PDF.
- Record income, expenses and debts. Amounts entered at any frequency are converted to a weekly figure.
- Weekly totals for income, expenses and money available update as you edit.
- The client sees a read-only version and can suggest a change rather than edit directly.

If you are a counsellor rather than a financial mentor, you can leave this section empty — it does not affect the counselling workflow or the client's progress tracker.

7. A typical counselling case, start to finish

1. An administrator creates the case and assigns it to you. You receive a notification and it appears on your dashboard.
2. Open the case. Complete Case basics, then Client & referral — source, date, funding stream.
3. Set Consent status. If consent is not yet written, raise an evidence request for the signed consent form and set the status to Waiting for Client.
4. Record Presenting concerns, Risk flags and Cultural considerations.
5. Once consent and any required documents are in, review each document and set it to Accepted or Needs replacement. Move the status to Adviser Reviewing.
6. Fill in Provider & sessions: provider name, sessions approved, first appointment. Set Next action and Who acts next.
7. When the referral is ready, set Ready to Submit, send it, then Record submission with the date, method and follow-up date.
8. Set Submitted, then Under Review once the provider or funder acknowledges.
9. Update Sessions used after each session, and keep Next appointment current.
10. On outcome, set Decision Made, then Closed when no further work is planned.

8. Good practice

- Update the status the same day something changes — the client's whole experience hangs off it.
- Write Next action as one thing the client can do today.
- Keep clinical detail summary-level; full notes belong in your clinical system.
- Record risk flags even when the risk is historic — the next person to open the case may not know the client.
- Use Adviser notes for anything you would not say to the client's face.
- Record every external submission, even a phone call, so the case has a defensible history.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
A case you expect is missing	It has not been assigned to you. Ask an administrator to assign it.
You land on a client dashboard, not the adviser one	You hold both roles. Sign out and back in, or use the adviser link in the banner.
Save changes button is greyed out	Nothing has changed since the last save.
A document will not open	Signed links expire. Return to the case and click view again.
An upload is rejected	Check the file size and format, and that you are on the correct case. If it persists, contact your administrator.
A client says they cannot see a request	Confirm the evidence request was created on the case they can see, and that the case is assigned and not in Draft.

10. Privacy and safety

- Only open cases you are assigned to and have a working reason to view.
- Documents are private; never forward a signed link outside the service.
- Do not record more personal or clinical information than the case genuinely needs.
- Confirm consent status before sharing anything with a third party.
- Waharoa does not currently send SMS or automated email to clients, and has no live government integrations — all external contact is made by you, outside the system.

Questions or access issues: contact your Waharoa administrator.